Reddit lost 1M+ search visits a week







...and its CEO is blaming Google's AI Mode

Sources: Reddit Q3 2026 letter to shareholders (SEC Exhibit 99.2), p. 4 · Search Engine Journal, Oct 30, 2026 (Q3 earnings call)
Photo: Steve Jurvetson, CC BY 2.0, cut out and recoloured

It's in Reddit's own shareholder letter

Our search referral traffic was down meaningfully in Q3, with the decline accelerating later in the quarter. The biggest impact was on logged-out and web traffic, but some of the impact flows through to logged-in and App traffic, since search referral is a common source of reengagement for users. The company helped to offset the declines by both driving reach primarily through user marketing and also by continuing to improve the product. These declines have continued into the early part of Q4. During October, we have seen that search traffic has dropped by more than 1 million referrals on average per week. If this rate of decline continues, current trends would suggest that total DAUqs could fall in Q4, by a low-double-digit percentage from our current base of 130 million DAUqs.

page 4 · hardest hit: logged-out web traffic

Source: Reddit Q3 2026 letter to shareholders (SEC Exhibit 99.2), p. 4

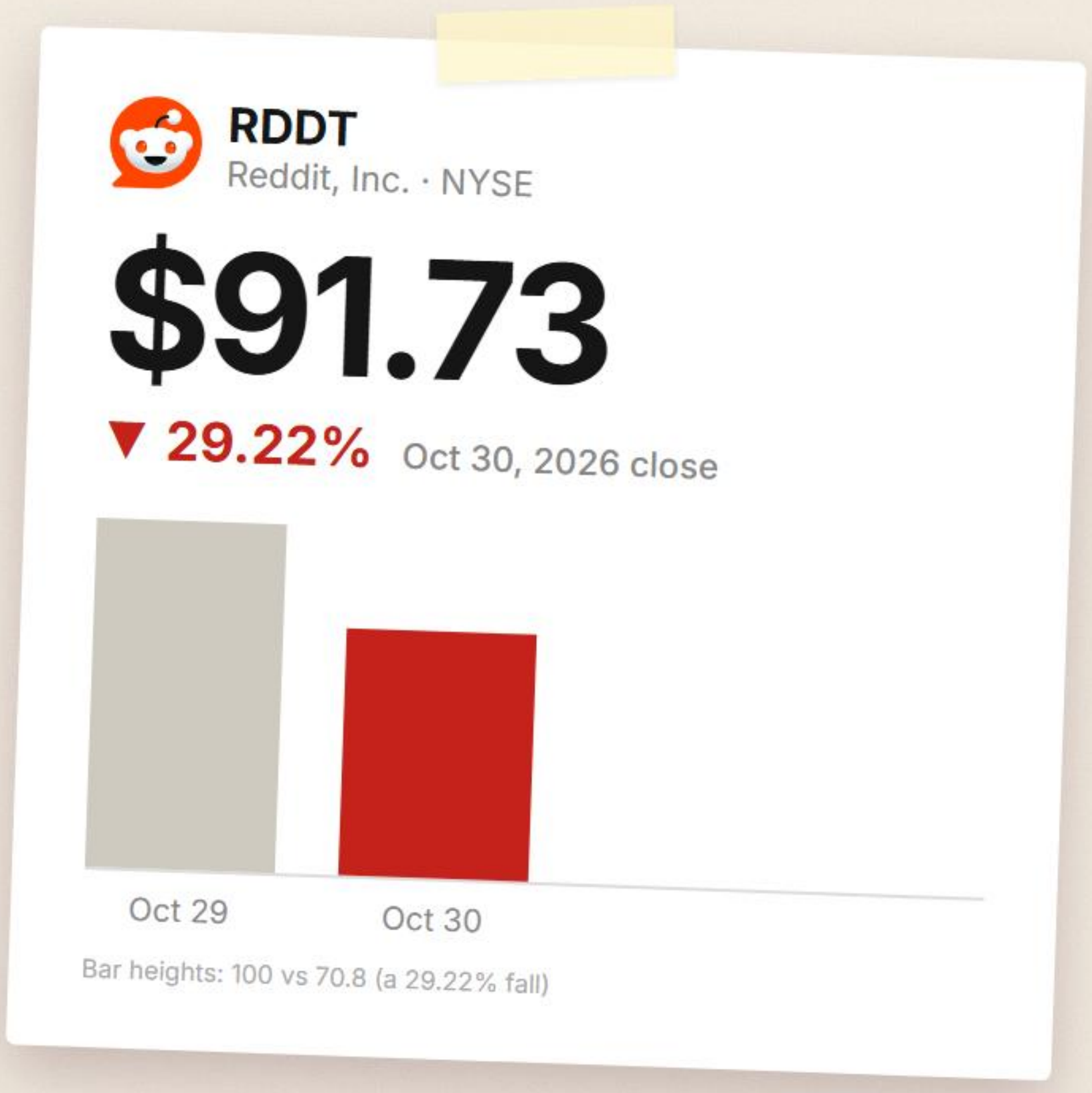
AI Mode "does not drive traffic"

– Steve Huffman, Reddit's CEO



Source: Search Engine Journal, Oct 30, 2026 (Q3 earnings call)
Photo: Steve Jurvetson, CC BY 2.0, cut out and recoloured

The next day, shares fell 29%



its biggest one-day drop ever

Source: The Globe and Mail, Oct 30, 2026

Google still crawls Reddit “as hard as ever”



the answer uses the thread... the click never comes

Quote: Search Engine Journal, Oct 30, 2026 (Q3 earnings call) · Search page drawn by TMV to show the idea

Stop counting clicks. Track the answer.

What an AI answer can give you

- ✓ Your brand named in the answer
- ✓ Your page cited as a source
- ✗ A visit to your site (not always)

Do AI answers name your brand?

you

CHECK

comment CHECK and we'll send you our free AI visibility checker ↓